Poem of Gilgameš – Old Babylonian Ishchali: “[…] Ḫuwawa”

- Source: eBL corpus – https://www.ebl.lmu.de/corpus/L/1/4/Old%20Babylonian/Ishchali
- API: https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts/L/1/4/chapters/Old%20Babylonian/Ishchali/display
- Edition: Andrew R. George (editor); Geraldina Rozzi (revision); Enrique Jiménez (revision)
- Translation: Andrew R. George
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Per line: **N** = normalized Akkadian reconstruction (`|` metrical foot, `||` caesura); **T** = eBL English translation; **L** = lemmas with eBL dictionary glosses; then notes, parallel lines, and the manuscripts' transliterations (ATF). Bibliography keys like [RN117: 889] are resolved in `bibliography.md` (RN117 = George 2003).

1'

- **N:** [… | h]uwāwa
- **T:** […] Ḫuwawa:
- **L:** *h]uwāwa* ← Humbaba I
- **Note:** See [RN117: 264]: “Given that in the later version of the text Enkidu’s incitement to kill is preceded by a lengthy conversation between Gilgameš and Huwawa, possibly this line should be restored to give ‘[Gilgameš said to him, to] Huwawa.’”

```
NērOB1 o 1'. [... h]u-wa-wa
```

2'

- **N:** […] … | ibakki | an[a …] …
- **T:** ‘[…] was crying for […,]
- **L:** *ibakki* ← bakû I “to weep”; *an[a* ← ana I “(*aš-š*… etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*…”

```
NērOB1 o 2'. [...] x i-ba-ki a-n[a ...] x
```

3'

- **N:** […] … | appali[s | …]
- **T:** […] I look at […]
- **L:** *appali[s* ← palāsu I “to look (at)”

```
NērOB1 o 3'. [...] x a-pa-li-i[s₂ ...]
```

4'

- **N:** […] | iṣbata[n]nêti
- **T:** […] took hold of us,
- **L:** *iṣbata[n]nêti* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”

```
NērOB1 o 4'. x [...] iṣ-ba-ta-[an]-ne#-ti
```

5'

- **N:** … […] … | [an]a ṣērīni
- **T:** … […] … before us.’
- **L:** *[an]a* ← ana I “(*aš-š*… etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*…”; *ṣērīni* ← ṣēru I “back, upperside”

```
NērOB1 o 5'. is-[...] x x-ne-em# [a-n]a ṣe₂#-ri#-ni
```

6'

- **N:** en[kīdu | an]a š[âšum | issaqqa]r[am] | ana gilgāmeš
- **T:** Enkidu said to him, to Gilgameš:
- **L:** *en[kīdu* ← Enkidu I; *an]a* ← ana I “(*aš-š*… etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*…”; *š[âšum* ← šâšu I “(to/of) him Bab., NA”; *issaqqa]r[am]* ← zakāru I “to speak, say”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*… etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*…”; *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I

```
NērOB1 o 6'. en!-[ki-du₁₀ a-n]a š[a-šum i-sa-qa]-ra#-[am] a#-na# {d#}GIŠ
```

7'

- **N:** nēr | huwāwa | ha[rharam | …] | … | ilīka
- **T:** ‘Smite Ḫuwawa, the [*ogre*, …] of your gods!
- **L:** *nēr* ← nêru I “to strike”; *huwāwa* ← Humbaba I; *ha[rharam* ← harharu I “villain, rogue O/jB”; *ilīka* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 264]: “On Huwawa as *harharum* see below, l. 30'. Though there and in l. 34 he spells the first syllable of this word with the signs *ha-ar*, the scribe also knew the sign *har* (l. 33: *hur-ša-nim*). What follows is not obviously restorable; perhaps *la na-r*]*a-mu ilīka*, ‘whom your gods bear no love’?”

```
NērOB1 o 7'. ne-er# hu#-wa-wa ha[r-ha-ra-am? x x] x-mu DINGIR-MEŠ-ka
```

8'

- **N:** […] … […] …
- **T:** […] … […] …,

```
NērOB1 o 8'. [x x x] x im# x [x (x) x]-tim
```

9'

- **N:** a[mmīnim] | … | t[ašt]akan | gimillam | ana ṣērīšu
- **T:** [*Why, my friend, have*] you had mercy on him?′
- **L:** *a[mmīnim]* ← ammīni I “why?”; *t[ašt]akan* ← šakānu I “to put, place, lay down”; *gimillam* ← gimillu I “pl. f. requital, favour friendly deed (for/as reward)”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ṣērīšu* ← ṣēru I “back, upperside”

```
NērOB1 o 9'. a[m-mi-nim?] x x x x ta#-[aš-t]a-ka-an gi-mi-lam | ($___$) a#-na# ṣ
```

10'

- **N:** gilgāmeš | [ana š]â[šum | issaqqara]m | ana enkīdu
- **T:** Gilgameš [said] to [him,] to Enkidu:
- **L:** *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I; *[ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *š]â[šum* ← šâšu I “(to/of) him Bab., NA”; *issaqqara]m* ← zakāru I “to speak, say”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I

```
NērOB1 o 10'. {d}GIŠ# [a-na š]a-[šum i-sa-qa-ra-a]m a#-na en-ki-du10
```

11'

- **N:** inannā-ma | ibr[ī || lī]tam | nešakkan-ma
- **T:** ‘Now, my friend, we must achieve victory!
- **L:** *inannā-ma* ← inanna I “now OAkk, Bab. absol., and after prep., *adi i.* till now, *kīma i.*...”; *ibr[ī* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”; *lī]tam* ← līt u I “M/jB pl. *līātu* power, victory”; *nešakkan-ma* ← šakānu I “to put, place, lay down”

```
NērOB1 o 11'. i-na-an#-na-ma ib#-r[i li]-ta#-am# ne-ša-ka-ma
```

12'

- **N:** melemmū | ihalliqū | ina qīšim
- **T:** The auras are escaping in the wood,

- **L:** *melemmū* ← melemmu I “mostly pl. fearsome radiance, aura Bab.(lit.) of deity, demon”; *ihalliqū* ← halāqu I “to be lost”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *qīšim* ← qīšu II “forest, wood O/jB”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_{3}$" b+4'

```
NērOB1 o 12'. me-le-em#-mu# i-ha-li#-qu₂ i-na qi₂#-ši-im
```

13'

- **N:** melemmū | ih[a]lliqū-ma | namrīrū | irrupū | ana erpi
- **T:** the auras are escaping and the radiant sheens are fading into the *mist.'*
- **L:** *melemmū* ← melemmu I “mostly pl. fearsome radiance, aura Bab.(lit.) of deity, demon”; *ih[a]lliqū-ma* ← halāqu I “to be lost”; *namrīrū* ← namrīru I “awe-inspiring radiance OAkk, Bab.(lit.)”; *irrupū* ← erēpu I “to cloud over (intrans.) O/jB, NA”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erpi* ← erpu I “clouded over j/NB, NA usu. *ūmu e.* cloudy day”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 263–264]: “Or, reading *irrubū*, 'entering' [instead of ‘fading’]. The masculine counterpart of the common *erpetu* otherwise appears only in *MSL* IV, p. 38, Emesal Voc. III 119–22, as a counterpart of *dungu*, ‘cloud’.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_{3}$" b+4'

```
NērOB1 o 13'. me-le-em#-mu i-ha-[a]l-li#-qu₂#-ma nam-ri-ru i#-ru-pu | ($___$) a-
```

14'

- **N:** enkīdu | ana šâšum | issaqqaram | ana gilgāmeš
- **T:** Enkidu said to him, to Gilgameš:
- **L:** *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *šâšum* ← šâšu I “(to/of) him Bab., NA”; *issaqqaram* ← zakāru I “to speak, say”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I

```
NērOB1 o 14'. en-ki-du₁₀ a-na ša-šum i-sa-qa-ra-am a-na {d}GIŠ
```

15'

- **N:** ibrī | iṣṣūram | bār-ma | êšam | illakū | watmūšu
- **T:** ‘My friend, catch a bird and where will its chicks go?
- **L:** *ibrī* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”; *iṣṣūram* ← iṣṣūru I “occas. f.”; *bār-ma* ← bâru I “to catch, trap (with a net etc.) Bab.”; *êšam* ← êšam I “whither? OB”; *illakū* ← alāku I “to go”; *watmūšu* ← watmu I “hatchling O/jB”

- **Note:** See [RN2651: 12]: “This part of Enkidu’s speech probably employs an adage or a proverb. Curiously, biblical law attests to a similar dictum, but looks at the same thematic components from a different – moral, not practical – point of view. Deut 22: 6 reads (JPS trans.): “If a bird’s nest chance to be before thee in the way, in any tree or on the ground, with young ones or eggs, and the dam sitting upon the young, or upon the eggs, thou shalt not take the dam with the young.” (I am indebted to Dr. A. Gai who turned my attention to this parallel.)”

```
NērOB1 o 15'. ib-ri i-ṣu₂-ra-am ba-ar-ma e-ša-am i-la-ku wa-at-mu-šu
```

16'

- **N:** melemmī | warkatam | i ništeʾi
- **T:** Let us look for the auras later,
- **L:** *melemmī* ← melemmu I “mostly pl. fearsome radiance, aura Bab.(lit.) of deity, demon”; *warkatam* ← warkatam I “adv. later, soon afterwards”; *i* ← i I “let's”; *ništeʾi* ← še'û I “also *šêʾu* to seek (out)”

```
NērOB1 b.e. 1. me-le-em-mi wa-ar-ka-tam i ne-iš-te-i
```

17'

- **N:** kīma (|) watmū | irtanappudū | iq-qīšim
- **T:** as the chicks run here and there in the wood!
- **L:** *kīma* ← kīma I “like”; *watmū* ← watmu I “hatchling O/jB”; *irtanappudū* ← rapādu II “to roam, wander”; *iq-qīšim* ← qīšu II “forest, wood O/jB”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 264]: “Although the scribe uses an apocopated preposition nowhere else, the writing *i-qí-ši-im* probably represents *iq-qīšim*. Bauer’s reading *di-ši-im*, ‘spring grass’, is not impossible.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 MB "Boğ₁" a+5'

```
NērOB1 b.e. 2. ki-i-ma wa-at-mu ir-ta-na-pu-du i-qi₂-ši-im
```

18'

- **N:** šâtu | tūr | nēr-ma | mut[abb]ilš[u] | nēr ...
- **T:** Smite him a second time and slay the one who serves him ...!’
- **L:** *šâtu* ← šâtu I “him”; *tūr* ← târu I “to turn, return”; *nēr-ma* ← nêru I “to strike”; *mut[abb]ilš[u]* ← wabālu I “(*cf.* also *babālu*) to carry, bring”; *nēr* ← nêru I “to strike”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 264]: “Von Soden’s reading of the last word as *i[t-t]i-šu* ([LS304: 219]) is not sustained by the traces.”

- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 MB "Boğ$_1$" r+7'

```
NērOB1 b.e. 3. ša-a-tu tu-ur₂ ne-er-ma mu-t[a-b]i-il-š[u] | ($___$) ne-er x x x
```

19'

- **N:** išme | gilgāmeš | siqir (|) rāʾēšu
- **T:** Gilgameš heard the word of his companion.
- **L:** *išme* ← šemû I “to hear”; *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I; *siqir* ← zikru I “jB st. constr. *siqar* utterance”; *rāʾēšu* ← rū'u I “colleague, friend”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 285

```
NērOB1 r 1. iš#-me {d#}GIŠ si₂-qi₂-ir ra-e-šu#
```

20'

- **N:** ilqe | haṣṣinnam | ina qātīšu
- **T:** He took up (his) axe in his hand,
- **L:** *ilqe* ← leqû II “to take, take over”; *haṣṣinnam* ← haṣṣinnu I “Mari, NB pl. f. axe of copper, silver, gold etc.”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *qātīšu* ← qātu I “f.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "IX" 15; cf. L I.4 SB "X" 93; cf. L I.4 SB "X" 99; cf. L I.4 SB "X" 110; cf. L I.4 SB "X" 159; cf. L I.4 SB "X" 164; cf. L I.6 SB "-" b+27

```
NērOB1 r 2. il-qe₂ ha-ṣi₂-nam i-na qa-ti-šu
```

21'

- **N:** išlup | namṣāram | ina šibbīšu
- **T:** he drew forth the dirk from his belt.
- **L:** *išlup* ← šalāpu I “to pull out, draw, unsheathe”; *namṣāram* ← namṣāru I; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *šibbīšu* ← šibbu I “belt Bab. (sword-)belt”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 286; cf. L I.4 SB "IX" 16; L I.4 SB "X" 94; L I.4 SB "X" 165; L I.6 SB "-" b+28

```
NērOB1 r 3. iš-lu-up nam-ṣa-ra-am# i#-na# ši#-ib#-bi-šu
```

22'

- **N:** gilgāmeš | inēr | kišādam
- **T:** Gilgameš smote the neck,
- **L:** *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I; *inēr* ← nêru I “to strike”; *kišādam* ← kišādu I “pl. f. neck”

- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 287

```
NērOB1 r 4. {d}GIŠ i-ne#-er# ki#-ša#-da#-am#
```

23'

- **N:** enkīdu | ibiršu || īpuš | libba
- **T:** Enkidu his friend *gave encouragement*.
- **L:** *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *ibiršu* ← ibru I "friend, colleague"; *īpuš* ← epēšu II "to do"; *libba* ← libbu I "inner body"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 265]: "The decipherment of the line's verb as *īpuš* makes it difficult to retain a literal translation of *libbam* (e.g. Dalley 'struck at (?) the heart', Pettinato 'trafisse il cuore', and Hecker '*traf* sein Herz'). With Lambert I understand the phrase *libbam epēšum* to mean 'give encouragement' (cf. his translation of ll. 19'–23' in [RN425: 42]), comparable with the well-known idiom *libbam šakānum*, 'to hearten, encourage, comfort'. However, the late version, though badly damaged at this point, gives Enkidu a more physical role and expands the line to include the lungs (SB V 265): *En*[*kīdu libba*? *il*]*putu adi ḫašê ištalpu*."
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 288

```
NērOB1 r 5. en-ki-du10 i-bi#-ir#-šu# i#-pu#-uš# li#-ib#-ba
```

24'

- **N:** … | imqut
- **T:** He … he fell,
- **L:** *imqut* ← maqātu I "to fall"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 265]: "To my eyes the beginning of the line cannot be read *i-ša-al-ši-* (Bauer); *i-ša-al-li-* also looks improbable."

```
NērOB1 r 6. i-ša-al-x x x x x [i]m-qu2-ut
```

25'

- **N:** dāmšu | ubbalū || … | harrū
- **T:** the ravines carrying … his blood.
- **L:** *dāmšu* ← dāmu I "blood"; *ubbalū* ← wabālu I "(*cf.* also *babālu*) to carry, bring"; *harrū* ← harru I "NB pl. f. water channel Bab., NA as city moat"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 265]: "The traces do not appear to allow *nen-šu-tum* (Bauer); [RN580: 126, fn. 25], also saw that the first word must be *dam-šu*."

```
NērOB1 r 7. dam-šu ub-ba#-lu# x# x# ha#-ar#-ru
```

26'

- **N:** huwāwa | maṣṣaram || inēr-ma | kaqqaram
- **T:** Ḫuwawa the guardian he smote to the ground,
- **L:** *huwāwa* ← Humbaba I; *maṣṣaram* ← maṣṣaru I “guard, watchman in comb., e.g. Am. *m. šarri* king's guard”; *inēr-ma* ← nêru I “to strike”; *kaqqaram* ← qaqqaru I “pl. m. & f. ground, earth”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 265]: “Given the vocalization, a reading *ka-bi-ra-am* derived from *kabrum, kabartum*, ‘stout’ (cf. Bottéro), is discounted and I retain Bauer’s *kaqqaram*.” See also [RN2651: 12]: “note the spatial-adverbial use of the acc. in *qaqqaram*, instead of a prepositional phrase or the term. adv. *-iš* (similarly also l. 37′ *qí-iš-tam*). The reason for this may be stylistic alternation, as the following line ends with *-iš* (*ru-qí-iš* “afar”).”

```
NērOB1 r 8. hu-wa-wa ma-ṣa-ra-am i#-ne#-er#-ma# ka#-qa₂-ra-am
```

27'

- **N:** ana šina (|) bēr | … | rūqiš
- **T:** for two leagues [(…)] afar.
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*… etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*…”; *šina* ← šina II “two (st. constr. *šin*”; *bēr* ← bēru III “double hour, league”; *rūqiš* ← rūqiš I “(from) afar M/jB”

```
NērOB1 r 9. a-na ši-na be₂-er [(x x)] ru#-qi₂#-iš
```

28'

- **N:** ittīšu | inēr | …
- **T:** With him he smote …,
- **L:** *ittīšu* ← itti I “with”; *inēr* ← nêru I “to strike”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 265]: “This couplet is the narrative that realizes Enkidu’s earlier instruction, *muttabilšu nēr* … (l. 18'), but the object in l. 28' cannot yet be read.”

```
NērOB1 r 10. it-ti-šu i#-ne#-er# x x x x x-ri-qi₄?
```

29'

- **N:** qišātim | … […] … […] …
- **T:** the forests he […] . . .
- **L:** *qišātim* ← qīšu II “forest, wood O/jB”

```
NērOB1 r 11. qi₂-ša-tim x [x] x x [x (x)]-u₂
```

30'

- **N:** inēr | harharam || maṣṣaru (|) qištim
- **T:** He slew the ogre, the forest's guardian,
- **L:** *inēr* ← nêru I "to strike"; *harharam* ← harharu I "villain, rogue O/jB"; *maṣṣaru* ← maṣṣaru I "guard, watchman in comb., e.g. Am. *m. šarri* king's guard"; *qištim* ← qištu I "pl. *qišātu(m)* forest, wood *q. erēnim* cedar forest"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 265–266]: "The reading *harharam* here and in l. 34' was discovered by A. Westenholz (see *AHw*, p. 1559). It has usually been translated 'scoundrel', 'villain' or similar (von Soden: 'Schurke'; Bottéro: 'scélérat'; Pettinato: 'brigante'; Tournay and Shaffer: 'vaurien'). The image of Huwawa as some kind of worthless rogue is not one that accords with what the epic tells us elsewhere. He is evil of aspect and an enemy of mankind, but guarding the cedar is his destined task and not a matter of villainy. In connected context the word *ḫarḫaru* is otherwise known only from the Theodicy, where it refers to some rascal undeserving of promotion (l. 77; cf. also l. 221). The translation 'scoundrel' is derived from the late synonym list *Malku* VIII 125–6 (*STT* 394) and the commentary on the Theodicy (see [RN432: 76 and 83]). In both *harharu* is associated with various rogues and social misfits: *ishappu*, *guzallu*, *šērum* (or *terrum*) and *kuluʾu*. Given what we know of Ḫuwawa, my suspicion is that *harharu* acquired the moral overtone of lawless behaviour as a late, secondary development and earlier meant simply something like 'monster', 'freak'. Huwawa's appearance was nothing if not monstrous."

```
NērOB1 r 12. i-ne-er ha-ar#-ha#-ra#-am# ma#-ṣa#-ru qi₂-iš-tim
```

31'

- **N:** ša ana rigmīšu | ultatti<ū> || saria (|) u labnān
- **T:** at whose yell *were split asunder* Sirion and Lebanon.
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I "who(m), which"; *ana* ← ana I "(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*..."; *rigmīšu* ← rigmu I "pl. f. voice, cry, noise voice of deity, human"; *ultatti<ū>* ← letû II "? to split Bab., MA?"; *saria* ← Sirara I; *u* ← u I "and, but, also"; *labnān* ← Labananu I
- **Note:** See [RN117: 266]: "Saria is the OB form of SB Sirara or Siraya, the Babylonian version of biblical and Ugaritic Mt Sirion (or Sarôn), which traditionally forms a pair with Mt Lebanon (see, e.g., [RN115: 217–18]; [temp_id_705850616004126: 119]). In recently published texts from Mari the two mountain ranges occur together as Sarian (sometimes contracted to Sarên) and Labnan (see [temp_id_2177152396606734: 88]). The present line attests to a tradition in which the high ridges either side of the Levantine Rift Valley were riven apart by Ḫuwawa's terrible yell. In the later text the rift is created instead during Gilgameš's wrestle with Ḫumbaba (SB V 133–4)."

```
NērOB1 r 13. ša a-na ri#-ig#-mi#-šu# ul#-ta#-ti-<u₂?> sa-ri-a u₃ la-ab-na-an
```

32'

- **N:** … […] … | šadî
- **T:** … the mountains …,
- **L:** *šadî* ← šadû I “st. constr. *šad(i)*”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 266]: “At the beginnings of these lines Bauer’s *ip-ša-ḫu* is definitely ruled out. Much as I would like to agree with Tournay and Shaffer’s *ip-šu pí-šu* ([RN580: 126, fnn. 32–3]), the traces do not support this reading of the second and third signs.”

```
NērOB1 r 14. ip-x x [x-š]u x x KUR-MEŠ
```

33'

- **N:** … […] … | irtutū | kala | huršānim
- **T:** … all the uplands trembled.
- **L:** *irtutū* ← ratātu I “to tremble jB”; *kala* ← kalû II “all, totality”; *huršānim* ← huršānu I “mountain(s) M/NB often pl.”

```
NērOB1 r 15. ip-x [x] x-šu ir#-tu-tu ka-la hur-ša-nim
```

34'

- **N:** inēr | harharam || maṣṣaru (|) qišti
- **T:** He slew the ogre, the cedar’s guardian,
- **L:** *inēr* ← nêru I “to strike”; *harharam* ← harharu I “villain, rogue O/jB”; *maṣṣaru* ← maṣṣaru I “guard, watchman in comb., e.g. Am. *m. šarri* king's guard”; *qišti* ← qištu I “pl. *qišātu(m)* forest, wood *q. erēnim* cedar forest”

```
NērOB1 r 16. i-ne-er# ha-ar-ha#-ra#-am# ma#-ṣa#-ru# {giš}EREN
```

35'

- **N:** hepûtim | … […] …
- **T:** the broken … […] …
- **L:** *hepûtim* ← hepû I “broken Bab., OA of pot, beams, house”

```
NērOB1 r 17a. he-pu-tim ra-x x x [x (x) x] x
```

35'b

- **N:** ištū-ma | sebet | inēru
- **T:** As soon as he had slain (all) seven,

- **L:** *ištū-ma* ← ištu I “from, out of”; *sebet* ← sebe I “f. *sebet(tu)* seven, *sebet ūmim sebe mušiātim* seven days (and)…”; *inēru* ← nêru I “to strike”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 266]: “A subordinating conjunction is unlikely to appear in the middle of a verse, so it seems that this long line must be two lines of poetry: *ḫepûtim ra…* [x] / *ištūma sebet inēru*. Otherwise one must read *iš-ṭú-ma … inērū*, ‘they spread out and slew’. I prefer to keep the verbs singular, like those of the following lines. Seven is the number of Ḫuwawa’s auras, of course, so that this line concludes the slaughter of his household.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 307

```
NērOB1 r 17b. iš#-tu-ma se-be₂-et i-ne-ru
```

36'

- **N:** šuškallam | ša š[itta?] (|) bilat? | u? namṣar | samāne (|) bilat
- **T:** the war-net of *two talents and* dirk of eight talents,
- **L:** *šuškallam* ← šuškallu I “f. & m. battle-net O/jB of gods”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *š[itta?]* ← šittu I “sleep Bab. good, bad”; *bilat?* ← biltu I “load”; *u?* ← u I “and, but, also”; *namṣar* ← namṣāru I; *samāne* ← samāne I “f. *šamānat*, *saman(ū)tu* eight, *samanti ūmē* eight days”; *bilat* ← biltu I “load”
- **Note:** See also [RN2651: 12]: “Though the total weight of the arms of the heroes in Y: iv 171 (p. 200, cf. 266 *ad* l. 37′) is also ten talents, the Ishchali tablet seems to have a different tradition regarding the weapons of the comrades, as Y tells nothing of a *šuškallum*-net.”

```
NērOB1 r 18. šu-uš-ka-al-lam ša# š[i-ta?] GU₂?# u₃?# nam#-ṣa-ar 8# GU₂#
```

37'

- **N:** biltam | ša ešer (|) bilat | ilqe
- **T:** a burden of ten talents he took up,
- **L:** *biltam* ← biltu I “load”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ešer* ← ešer I “f. *ešeret* ten (before m. subst. *ešeret*, *eše/arti*”; *bilat* ← biltu I “load”; *ilqe* ← leqû II “to take, take over”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "III" 171

```
NērOB1 r 19a. bil-tam ša 10 GU₂ il₅-qe₂!
```

37'b

- **N:** urid-ma | irtahi<ṣ> | qištam
- **T:** he went down and trampled through the forest.
- **L:** *urid-ma* ← warādu I “to go down”; *irtahi<ṣ>* ← rahāṣu I “to flood”; *qištam* ← qištu I “pl. *qišātu(m)* forest, wood *q. erēnim* cedar forest”

- **Note:** See [RN117: 266]: “It seems that here also two poetic lines are squeezed on to one line of tablet. (…)”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "IM" 17

```
NērOB1 r 19b. u₂-ri#-id#-ma# ir-ta-hi-<iṣ> qi₂-iš-tam
```

38'

- **N:** mūšab (|) anunnakkī || puzzuram | ipte
- **T:** He discovered the secret abode of the Anunnaki,
- **L:** *mūšab* ← mūšabu I “dwelling, domicile, abode”; *anunnakkī* ← Anunnakkū I “(the) gods”; *puzzuram* ← puzzuru I “MB f. *punzurtu* concealed O/MB of divine dwelling”; *ipte* ← petû II “to open”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 266]: “(…) The alternative to the ‘sandhi’ writing proposed by Bauer (= *puzzuram ipte*), is to read *pu-sú-um-mi ip-te*, ‘he opened the veils’ ([parpola_standard_1997: 238]; cf. already Pettinato, Tournay and Shaffer, Westenholz). The objections to this analysis are that (a) *pusummum* seems to be only a garment, not a curtain of the kind used in temples (which is *šiddum*), and (b) with no preposition before *mūšab ilī*, *ipte* would be forced to govern two objects. In either analysis the image is of the violation of the most sacred part of a sanctuary, which is normally hidden from human gaze. The tradition in which the mountain of the Cedar Forest is the home of the gods is not native to Babylonia; see Chapter 10, the introduction to SB V.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "IM" 18

```
NērOB1 r 20. mu-ša-ab e-nu-na-ki pu-zu-ra#-mi ip-te-e
```

39'

- **N:** gilgāmeš | iṣṣī | ubattaq | enkīdu | uharra | urbazillī
- **T:** Gilgameš felling the trees, Enkidu choosing the *best timber*.
- **L:** *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I; *iṣṣī* ← iṣu I “pl. m. *iṣṣū*, OA also f. tree”; *ubattaq* ← batāqu I “to cut off, divide, tear off”; *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *uharra* ← hiāru I “to choose”; *urbazillī* ← urmazillu I “tree-stump? OB”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 266]: “I read *urbazillī* (Bauer: *ur-ma-zi-li*; see *AHw* s.v. *urmazillu*) in the light of the later text, which has *hur-ba-zal-lu* (…), presumably a form of the same word. The customary understanding of the last two words is that Enkidu was digging up the tree-stumps. Tree-stumps are not useful as lumber, and now that the later text has the verb *ištene″â* it is clear that in this line *ú-ha-ra* is from *hiʾārum* (*uharra*, ventive) not *herûm*. The II/1 stem, previously unattested for *ḫiʾārum*, suits the plurality of the object the verb governs. As I see it, while Gilgameš fells one tree Enkidu is busy choosing the next (cf. already Tournay and Shaffer: ‘Enkidu choisit une bille de bois rare’).”

- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 311-312

```
NērOB1 r 21. {d}GIŠ i-ṣi₂ u₂-ba-ta-aq en-ki-du₁₀ u₂-ha-ra ur-ba-zi-li
```

40'

- **N:** enkīdu | ana šâšum || issaqqaram | ana gilgāmeš
- **T:** Enkidu said to him, to Gilgameš,
- **L:** *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *šâšum* ← šâšu I “(to/of) him Bab., NA”; *issaqqaram* ← zakāru I “to speak, say”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I

```
NērOB1 r 22. en#-ki#-du₁₀# a#-na# ša#-šum# i-sa-qa-ra-am a-na {d}GIŠ
```

41'

- **N:** [...] | gilgāmeš | nēr | erēnam
- **T:** ‘[...] Gilgameš, smite the cedar!
- **L:** *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I; *nēr* ← nêru I “to strike”; *erēnam* ← erēnu I “cedar OAkk *qišti e.* cedar forest”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 266]: “From the parallel passages in OB IM and SB V it is likely that Enkidu is pointing out to Gilgameš the tree he wants felled in order to make the door for Enlil’s temple. The measurement of 30 reeds is the equivalent of about 90 metres.”

```
NērOB1 r 23. [x x x x x] {d#}GIŠ ne-er {giš}EREN
```

42'

- **N:** [... | š]a itêka
- **T:** [...] at your side,
- **L:** *š]a* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *itêka* ← itû I “pl. m. & f. boundary”

```
NērOB1 r 24. [x x x x x š]a i-te-e-ka
```

43'

- **N:** [...] | šalāšā | qana
- **T:** [...] thirty reeds long.
- **L:** *šalāšā* ← šalāšā I “thirty”; *qana* ← qanû I “pl. m. & f. reed, cane”

```
NērOB1 r 25. [x x x x x x x] 30# GI
```

a+1

- **N:** […] … | purattim | … […] …
- **T:** […] … Euphrates …
- **L:** *purattim* ← Purattu I
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 318

```
NērOB1 l.e. 1. [x x x] x x x [x x]-ri#-im pu-ra-tim x [(x)-l]i
```

a+2

- **N:** […] … | erēnam
- **T:** […] … cedar.
- **L:** *erēnam* ← erēnu I “cedar OAkk *qišti e.* cedar forest”

```
NērOB1 l.e. 2. [x x (x)] x x x x x x {giš}EREN
```